

UK Road Safety Analysis 2024

Data Source: UK Department for Transport | Analyst: Subashini | Date: May 2026

PROJECT OVERVIEW

This analysis examines 100,927 road collisions reported in Great Britain during 2024 using data from the UK Department for Transport STATS19 system. The dataset includes collision details, casualties and vehicle information.

KEY FINDINGS

- 1. SEVERITY: 75.16% of accidents were slight, 23.35% serious and 1.49% fatal
 - approximately 4 people die on UK roads every single day
- 2. DAY OF WEEK: Friday was most dangerous with 16,444 accidents
 - Sunday was safest with 11,388 accidents
- 3. TIME OF DAY: Peak accident hours are 5PM (8,784) and 4PM (8,487)
 - coinciding with evening rush hour traffic
- 4. ROAD TYPE: Single carriageway roads account for majority of accidents
 - despite lower speed limits than motorways
- 5. URBAN VS RURAL: Urban areas had more accidents (67,304 vs 33,620)
 - but Rural areas had higher fatal percentage due to higher speeds
- 6. DRIVER AGE: Drivers aged 26-35 most frequently involved (35,205)
 - older drivers 56-65 showed higher fatality rate relative to accident count
- 7. WEATHER: Most accidents occurred in fine weather (no wind)
 - showing overconfidence in good conditions is a key risk factor

RECOMMENDATIONS

- 1. Increase road patrols on Fridays during peak hours 4PM to 6PM
- 2. Implement targeted road safety campaigns for drivers aged 26-35
- 3. Improve single carriageway road infrastructure and signage
- 4. Install additional speed enforcement on rural roads to reduce fatal rate
- 5. Launch public awareness campaign about overconfidence in fine weather

DATA QUALITY NOTES

- 1. Zero NULL values found in all key columns confirming complete dataset
- 2. 3 records with invalid speed limit (-1) excluded from speed analysis
- 3. 2,552 casualty records with invalid age (-1) excluded from age analysis
- 4. 3 records with unclassified urban/rural code labelled as Urban or Rural